



Amritapuri | Chennai
Kanpur | Mathura

The 2026 ICPC India Preliminary Online Contest

Contest Environment, Rules & Instructions

Contest Date: October 03, 2026

Contest Time: 1:30 PM – 4:30 PM IST

Applicable to: Teams registered for the **Amritapuri, Chennai, Kanpur and Mathura** regional sites

Please read these instructions carefully before the contest. **Every team member is responsible for understanding and following all the rules.**

1. Contest Platform & Computer Requirements

The contest will be conducted on the **CodeChef Platform** using **Safe Exam Browser (SEB)**.

Safe Exam Browser

Download SEB ONLY from the official CodeChef SEB page: <https://www.codechef.com/seb-guidelines>

Do not download or install SEB from any other website.

The current CodeChef SEB requirements are:

- Windows 10 or later
- macOS 15 or later
- **Linux is NOT supported.**

Use the **latest SEB version provided on the CodeChef page**. The current CodeChef downloads are:

- Windows: **SEB 3.10.1.864**
- macOS: **SEB 3.6.1**

If an older version of SEB is already installed, **uninstall it before installing the version supported by CodeChef.**



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2. One Team — One Computer

Each team will be provided with **one unique team login ID**.

The following rules are mandatory:

- The login ID is strictly for the registered team and must not be shared with anyone outside the team.
- **Only ONE computer may be used by a team for the entire contest.**
- The computer may be a personal laptop or a college-provided laptop/desktop.
- The system you are using should have both a working **camera and a microphone**.
- All participating team members must work together using this same computer.
- All participating team members must be physically present together at the same location.
- No additional laptops, desktops, tablets, mobile phones or other electronic devices may be used.
- No additional monitor, keyboard or other setup may be used to allow another participant to work separately.
- The team login must not be used on another computer or browser after the contest has been started on the designated computer.

One team = one computer = one contest login.

3. Camera & Team Visibility

All participating team members must remain visible on camera throughout the contest.

When starting the assessment:

1. **Only ONE team member must be visible on camera.**
2. The assessment **will not start** if more than one team member is visible at this stage.
3. **Once the assessment has started, the other participating team members must come into view.**
4. From that point onward, **all participating team members must remain visible on camera for the entire contest.**
5. All participating members must remain together at the same physical location.

The camera must be positioned so that the organizers can clearly verify the participating team members.

Failure to comply with the camera or team-visibility requirements may result in disqualification.



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4. Safe Exam Browser — Strict Restrictions

Once the assessment has started:

DO NOT:

- Switch tabs.
- Switch windows.
- Switch applications.
- Open another application or program.
- Access the desktop or other parts of the operating system.
- Exit Safe Exam Browser.
- Use another browser.
- Access external websites.
- Use another computer or device.
- Use a mobile phone or tablet.
- Use remote desktop or remote-access software.
- Run the contest inside a Virtual Machine.

Any tab switch, window switch or application switch will trigger the configured SEB restriction and may lock the team out of the contest.

Teams should not expect the organizers to restore access or provide additional time if they are locked out because of an unauthorized action.

5. Internet, AI & External Assistance

The following are strictly prohibited:

- Internet browsing outside the contest environment
- Google or other search engines
- ChatGPT, Gemini, Claude, Copilot or other AI tools
- AI-assisted programming tools
- Online forums or discussion platforms
- WhatsApp, Telegram, Discord or other communication platforms
- Communication with other teams
- Communication with anyone outside the team
- Remote assistance
- Any other form of external help

Team members may discuss and collaborate only with the other registered members of their own team.



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6. Allowed Notes

Teams may use their own **printed/written notes** during the contest.

There is no prescribed restriction on the size or format of such notes.

However:

- Notes must be physically available to the team. No soft copy
- Online repositories, websites or external code libraries may not be accessed.
- Pre-existing executable programs or external software may not be used to solve problems.
- Pre-saved source-code templates are not available in the contest environment.

Teams should therefore be prepared to **type their required code templates manually**.

7. Coding Environment & Supported Languages

Teams must use the **IDE/compiler provided inside the CodeChef contest environment**.

The permitted languages are:

Language	CodeChef compiler/interpreter currently listed
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C	GCC 11.3
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C++	GCC 13.2 — C++20
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Java	OpenJDK 21
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Kotlin	Kotlin 1.9.0
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Python	Python 3.11.2
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PyPy	PyPy 7.3.11
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Teams should use the mock contest to verify the coding environment before the actual contest.

Copying and pasting into or out of the contest environment is not permitted.



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8. Notifications & System Preparation

Before starting the contest:

- Disable all system notifications.
- Enable **Do Not Disturb**.
- Close unnecessary applications.
- Close Chrome, Teams, Zoom and other background applications.
- Disable screen-sharing applications.
- Disable automatic system updates/restarts.
- Ensure the computer has sufficient power or is connected to a reliable power source.
- Ensure that the camera and microphone are working.
- Ensure that the internet connection is stable.

An unexpected notification or application activity may interfere with SEB and may result in the assessment being locked.

9. Team Location & Invigilation

Teams must sit together in a **lab, classroom or other location approved by their college**.

The coach/HOD must ensure that:

- The team is present at the designated location.
- A staff member is present to invigilate the team for the entire contest.
- The invigilator follows the requirements specified in the undertaking/declaration.
- No unauthorized person assists the team.

10. Team Members

The team must consist only of its registered contestants.

If one registered team member is unable to participate, the remaining registered team members may participate, subject to the applicable ICPC rules.

No substitute or unregistered participant may take the place of a registered team member.



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11. ICPC Scoring & Submission Penalties

The contest follows the **standard ICPC scoring system**.

Teams are ranked primarily by:

1. **Number of problems solved**, and
2. **Total penalty time** among teams solving the same number of problems.

For each problem that is eventually solved:

- The time from the beginning of the contest until the first accepted submission is added to the team's total time.
- **20 penalty minutes are added for every incorrect submission made before the accepted submission for that problem.**
- **Compilation errors do not incur the 20-minute penalty.**
- A problem that is not eventually solved does not contribute to penalty time.

Therefore, teams should test their solutions carefully before submitting.

12. Submissions

- Only submissions made through the CodeChef contest environment during the official contest period will be considered.
- Late submissions will not be accepted.
- Teams are responsible for ensuring that their submissions are successfully submitted before the contest ends.
- After the contest ends, no further submissions will be accepted.

13. Plagiarism & Code Similarity

All submissions will be checked for plagiarism and code similarity.

The organizers may use:

- Automated code-similarity detection
- Manual examination by judges
- Comparison of submissions between teams



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- Other relevant evidence

Copying another team's solution or obtaining external assistance is strictly prohibited.

A team found to have committed plagiarism or malpractice may be **disqualified**. Serious or confirmed malpractice may also result in further disciplinary action, including a ban from future ICPC events, as determined under the applicable rules.

14. Technical Problems

Teams are responsible for their own:

- Computer
- Internet connection
- Power supply
- Camera
- Microphone
- SEB installation
- Login credentials
- Physical setup

Local technical problems will not qualify a team for additional contest time.

Teams must therefore use the mock contest to identify and resolve technical problems before the actual contest.

15. Undertaking — MANDATORY

Every team must submit the ICPC India Preliminary Round Undertaking before participating in the contest.

The undertaking must be submitted **once per team**.

If a team is registered for two regional sites, both site-specific ICPC Global Team IDs must be included in the same undertaking submission.

Undertaking and submission instructions:

<https://www.indiaicpc.in/#undertaking>



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A team that has not submitted the required undertaking may not be permitted to participate.

Add this to your pre-contest checklist:

- ☐ Undertaking completed and submitted
- ☐ Team Global ID(s) correctly entered
- ☐ Coach/institutional declaration completed as required

16. Mock Contests

Teams should complete the **CodeChef mock assessments using the same computer and setup** they will use for the actual contest.

Each team will receive **test credentials and an access link by email**. Use these credentials to access the mock assessments. No other credentials will work.

Three mock assessments are available. Teams are strongly advised to complete all three. They can be taken any time before 1 PM on October 3rd. Once taken they won't be available again.

Mock Contest 1 (**Link 1**): <https://www.codechef.com/skill-test/BDFBK>

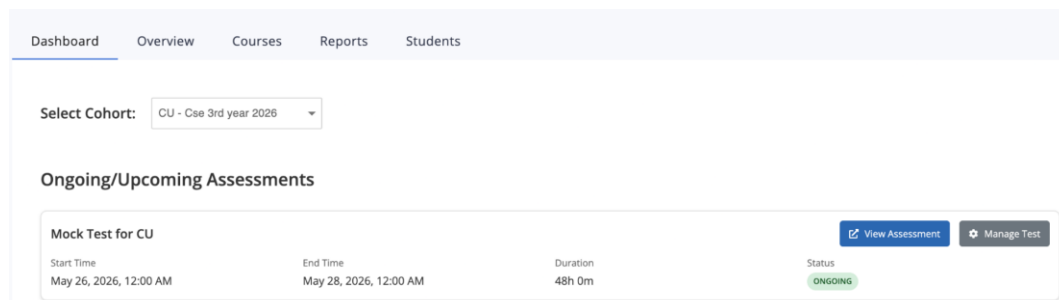
Mock Contest 2 (**Link 2**): <https://www.codechef.com/skill-test/BDJBZL>

Mock Contest 3 (**Link 3**): Will be shared later

We strongly recommend completing the **full mock contest**.

After logging in:

1. You will be redirected to the **CodeChef dashboard**.
2. Your assigned assessment/contest will be visible on the dashboard.





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Click **View Assessment** and then select: **Open in Safe Exam Browser**

Mock Test for CU



2 Day
Total time to attempt the assessment

7 Questions
Programming problems and MCQs

Suraj Sharma
CodeChef Username: surajmsharma
IP - [REDACTED] (Allowed for this test)

Read the rules carefully before starting

- You can only attempt this assessment once.
- You will not be able to pause the assessment after starting.
- you are not allowed to switch tabs during the assessment, otherwise you will be blocked from the assessment.
- You will get a detailed report on your performance at the end of the assessment.

This exam requires Safe Exam Browser

Click below to open this exam directly in Safe Exam Browser.

Open in Safe Exam Browser

Safe Exam Browser not installed? [Download it here](#) or use the [alternative link](#)

After Safe Exam Browser opens:

1. Log in using the assigned team credentials.
2. Click Start Assessment.

Mock Test for CU



2 Day
Total time to attempt the assessment

7 Questions
Programming problems and MCQs

Suraj Sharma
CodeChef Username: surajmsharma
IP - [REDACTED] (Allowed for this test)

Read the rules carefully before starting

- You can only attempt this assessment once.
- You will not be able to pause the assessment after starting.
- you are not allowed to switch tabs during the assessment, otherwise you will be blocked from the assessment.
- You will get a detailed report on your performance at the end of the assessment.

☒ I agree to participate fairly in the assessment

Start Assessment

Use the mock contest to verify:



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- ☐ SEB installation
- ☐ Correct SEB version
- ☐ Windows/macOS compatibility
- ☐ Team login
- ☐ Camera
- ☐ Microphone
- ☐ Internet connection
- ☐ CodeChef contest interface
- ☐ Compiler/IDE
- ☐ Submission process
- ☐ Team camera positioning
- ☐ Notifications disabled
- ☐ Do Not Disturb enabled

Do not wait until the day of the contest to discover a technical problem.

17. Final Team Checklist

Before the contest, every team should confirm:

- ☐ One computer only
- ☐ No additional computer/device
- ☐ No mobile phone or tablet
- ☐ All participating team members are physically together
- ☐ Camera working
- ☐ Microphone working
- ☐ Stable internet
- ☐ Reliable power
- ☐ Windows 10+ or macOS 15+
- ☐ Correct SEB version installed from CodeChef
- ☐ Older SEB version removed
- ☐ Notifications disabled
- ☐ Do Not Disturb enabled
- ☐ Automatic updates/restarts disabled
- ☐ Mock and contest logins both received and tested
- ☐ Mock contest completed
- ☐ Undertaking submitted



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- ☐ Team understands the camera requirement
- ☐ Team understands the no-tab-switch rule
- ☐ Team understands the no-internet/no-AI rule
- ☐ Team understands the one-computer rule
- ☐ Team understands the ICPC 20-minute submission penalty
- ☐ Printed or handwritten notes ready if needed(no soft copies)
- ☐ Only one member visible on camera when starting the assessment
- ☐ Ensure that Team is using Windows 10 or later or macOS 15 or later and not

18. Final Rules

Violation of any contest rule may result in **immediate disqualification**.

The **Regional Contest Director and judges** will have the authority to adjudicate rule violations and unforeseen contest situations. Their decisions, made in accordance with the applicable contest rules, will be final.

The organizers reserve the right to modify technical instructions or contest procedures when necessary. Any material changes will be communicated through the official communication channels.

Every team is responsible for reading and understanding these instructions before the contest.